

Intellectual Property & Digitalization

- IT 250 – Digital Economy
- Unit 5: Economics of Information

What Are Ideas?

- Ideas come from your brain
- Songs, drawings, apps, stories are ideas
- Ideas can be valuable like money

Owning Ideas

- When you create something, it belongs to you
- Ideas are not physical but still owned
- Others should not copy without permission

What Is Intellectual Property?

- Intellectual Property means owning ideas
- Protects what your brain creates
- Law says: Don't steal ideas

Why IP Is Needed

- Without IP, people copy freely
- Creators lose money
- Creativity will stop

Copyright – Simple Meaning

- Protects songs, movies, books, videos
- Stops copying without permission
- Very important online

Copyright Example (Nepal)

- Nepali singer uploads a song
- Someone re-uploads without permission
- Copyright law says this is wrong

Patent – Simple Meaning

- Protects new inventions
- Only inventor can sell for some time
- Encourages innovation

Patent Example

- New water filter invented
- Patent stops others from copying
- Inventor earns from idea

Trademark – Simple Meaning

- Protects brand name and logo
- Prevents fake copies
- Avoids customer confusion

Trademark Example (Nepal)

- Daraz logo
- Pathao name
- Fake brands are illegal

What Is Digitalization?

- Everything moves online
- Easy to copy and share
- Hard to control information

Digitalization – Good Side

- Creators reach global audience
- Cheap and fast distribution
- New income opportunities

Digitalization – Bad Side

- Easy piracy and theft
- Creators lose income
- Hard to enforce laws

What Is Piracy?

- Using paid content for free
- Without permission
- Without payment

Piracy Example

- Downloading movies illegally
- Using cracked software
- Sharing paid apps freely

Online Platforms & IP

- YouTube, Facebook host content
- Use systems to detect copying
- Remove copyrighted content

Platform Challenges

- Too much content
- Hard to monitor everything
- Mistakes can happen

AI and Creativity

- AI can write, draw, and make music
- AI creates new content
- Raises ownership questions

AI Ownership Problem

- Who owns AI content?
- User, developer, or company?
- Laws are still unclear

IP Problems in Nepal

- Low awareness
- High piracy
- Small creators suffer

Why Strong IP Helps Nepal

- Protects creators
- Encourages innovation
- Supports digital economy

Need for Balance

- Too strict blocks sharing
- Too loose encourages theft
- Balanced approach needed

What Government Can Do

- Stronger laws
- Easy registration
- Awareness programs

What Creators Can Do

- Register their work
- Use watermarks
- Use platform tools

What Users Should Do

- Respect creators
- Avoid piracy
- Pay for content

Summary

- IP protects ideas
- Digitalization increases risk
- AI creates new challenges
- Nepal must balance protection and access

Discussion Question

- If everything is copied freely,
- Will people still create?
- Why is IP important?